Fair Test Practical · Knowledge Organiser

Learning goal: I can record repeated results, spot an odd reading, and use the data to answer our question.

Today I Can

I can follow our fair-test plan and record three trials for each parachute size.

I can spot an anomalous (odd) reading that does not fit the pattern.

I can write a conclusion that quotes the numbers and links canopy size to air resistance.

Must-Know Words

air resistance: a frictional force from air pushing against a moving object

repeat trials: doing the exact same test more than once to check the readings match

anomaly: an odd result that is very different from the other repeats

conclusion: a scientific answer that uses the recorded numbers to explain the pattern

Core Science Steps

First, check the three repeats for each size: Small (1.2, 1.3, 1.1 s), Medium (2.1, 2.0, 2.2 s), Large (3.4, 3.5, 3.3 s).

Second, find the typical (middle or mean) value for each: 1.2 s, 2.1 s, and 3.4 s.

Third, link the numbers to the science: larger canopy area increases air resistance, slowing the fall.

Keep the Science Clear

State the pattern, quote the data with units, and explain the air-resistance force.

Stopwatch timing by hand always has a small human reaction-time uncertainty (around 0.2 seconds).